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<https://russelldudek.github.io/Vanta/>

First 90 days: read deeply, ship narrowly.

A role-appropriate entry plan for building reliable automation capacity inside Vanta Recruiting and People.

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DAYS 1-30 · READ AND BASELINE

Understand the work before automating it.

Objectives

- Build trust with Recruiting, Recruiting Operations, People Operations, People Systems, hiring managers, coordinators, and knowledge owners.
- Map the current automation and agent portfolio: what exists, what is adopted, what fails, who owns it, and where knowledge comes from.
- Observe real work across sourcing, scheduling, candidate communication, offer-to-hire, reporting, and representative People processes.
- Define a lightweight People Automation Warranty and opportunity scorecard.

Core activities

Workflow listening

Shadow representative pod work; capture manual touches, exceptions, workarounds, candidate/employee friction, decision rights, and existing tool behavior.

Architecture reading

Understand Ashby workflows, Dust agents/skills/connectors, Claude use, Zapier, scripts, TeamOhana, Juicebox, LinkedIn, Checkr, Jira, HiBob, Workday, and system boundaries.

Knowledge audit

Map Confluence/Guru sources, owners, freshness, permissions, retrieval gaps, duplication, and missing operating definitions.

Portfolio baseline

Classify workflows by value, manual burden, variability, data readiness, risk, owner strength, adoption burden, reuse, and maintenance load.

Day-30 outputs

- Current-state workflow and ownership map.
- Automation/agent inventory with keep, repair, observe, or retire hypotheses.
- Warranty standard and launch checklist.
- Baseline scorecard and opportunity shortlist.
- One Recruiting thin slice and one People thin slice selected with accountable owners.

Working agreements to establish

Business ownership

Every workflow has a Recruiting or People owner who defines the outcome, participates in testing, and owns adoption.

Systems partnership

Changes touching architecture, access, core data structure, or platform configuration move with People Systems—not around it.

Human authority

Sensitive candidate and employee decisions remain explicit; automation supports rather than laundering accountability.

Observable failure

Exceptions must be visible, attributable, recoverable, and useful for improving the next release.

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DAYS 31-60 · BUILD AND VERIFY

Ship thin production slices into real work.

Objectives

- Deliver measurable manual-work reduction without hiding exceptions or human authority.
- Establish practical Ashby-first patterns and clear boundaries across Dust, Claude, Zapier, scripts, and People Systems.
- Instrument workflow behavior, recovery, experience, and adoption from launch.

Representative thin slices

Recruiting slice
Example: interview scheduling with deterministic availability logic, exception classification, approved communications, coordinator recovery, and time-to-schedule instrumentation.

People slice
Example: recurring reporting pipeline with source-linked definitions, scripted validation, AI-assisted summary, visible freshness, and owner-approved interpretation.

Knowledge slice
Restructure one high-use knowledge domain into owned, retrievable, permission-aware content for Dust agents and People users.

Build patterns
Reusable connectors, skills, logging, error messages, ownership metadata, change tests, and documentation templates.

Verification cadence

Weekly signal	Question	Action
Flow	Did manual touches and cycle time change?	Remove friction or narrow scope.
Reliability	Where did the workflow fail or create rework?	Repair controls and fallback.
Experience	Did recruiters, coordinators, candidates, or employees understand the result?	Fix context, language, or ownership.
Adoption	Are users retaining, bypassing, or modifying the workflow?	Train, redesign, or stop.
Knowledge	Was the agent grounded in current, authorized material?	Repair source or owner.

Adoption plan

Build with users
Recruiters, coordinators, People partners, and owners shape the thin slice, test exceptions, and approve the operating standard.

Teach from the work
Short demos show what changed, why the mechanism fits, what remains human, and how to recover when it fails.

Watch bypass behavior
Edits, workarounds, manual overrides, and abandoned paths become product evidence rather than user resistance to dismiss.

Close the loop
Publish decisions, changes, owners, known limits, and the next review so users know the workflow is maintained.

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DAYS 61-90 · STANDARDIZE AND SPREAD

Turn proven workflows into a maintained capability.

Objectives

- Scale only patterns that survive real work and earn ownership.
- Create an operating cadence across Recruiting, People Operations, and People Systems.
- Increase team AI fluency through examples, decision rules, and direct participation.
- Make maintenance, knowledge changes, and retirement normal parts of shipping.

Operating system

Portfolio review
Monthly review of value, reliability, adoption, risk, maintenance load, and next decision: scale, repair, human-led, retire.

Launch standard
Warranty, owner, source, action boundary, fallback, instrumentation, documentation, accessibility, security, and change test.

Knowledge protocol
Named owners, freshness expectations, change notifications, permission model, retrieval test, and retirement process.

Fluency system
Build demos, office hours, reusable examples, failure reviews, and champion participation tied to actual People work.

Day-90 readout

Decision	Evidence required
Scale	Reliable performance, clear owner, retained adoption, positive workflow economics, reusable pattern.
Repair	Value signal exists, but source, exception, authority, reliability, or usability remains weak.
Keep human-led	Work is low-volume, high-context, sensitive, or too variable for safe automation.
Retire	Low use, poor value, stale source, high maintenance, duplicated capability, or unacceptable trust burden.

Operating cadence

Weekly build review
Current slices, exceptions, user feedback, source changes, reliability, and next intervention.

Monthly portfolio review
Value, economics, adoption, maintenance burden, reuse, and scale / repair / human-led / retire decisions.

Quarterly architecture review
Connectors, permissions, data structures, knowledge ownership, tool changes, and platform boundaries.

Failure learning
Material failures produce a corrected mechanism, documented reason, and regression check—not a quiet workaround.